SPX Options Flow — Weekly Macro Briefing

Weekly Options Flow & Dealer Positioning Analysis

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▼ SHORT GAMMA

RISK: EXTREME

Composite Score: **-0.07**

SPX SPOT	NET GEX	GAMMA FLIP	DIST. TO FLIP	CALL WALL #1	PUT WALL #1
6,577	-4666.98B	5,992	+8.9%	6,650	6,600

MAX PAIN	VIX
6,690	25.76

Dealers are in SHORT GAMMA with net GEX of $-4666.98B. Spot (6,577) sits 8.9% above the gamma flip level (5,992). Composite macro score: -0.07 → Risk Level: EXTREME. Key risks: BEARISH_VOL_BUY, OPEX 1DTE, BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY.

REGIME PLAYBOOK

▲ EQUITIES
Reduce net delta, buy downside puts for protection

◆ VOLATILITY
Long VIX, buy volatility — trend moves may persist

◆ OPTIONS STRATEGY
Long straddles, buy gamma for directional exposure

◆ POSITION SIZING
Reduce 30–50% — elevated tail risk in short-gamma regime

GEX Profile — Dealer Gamma Exposure

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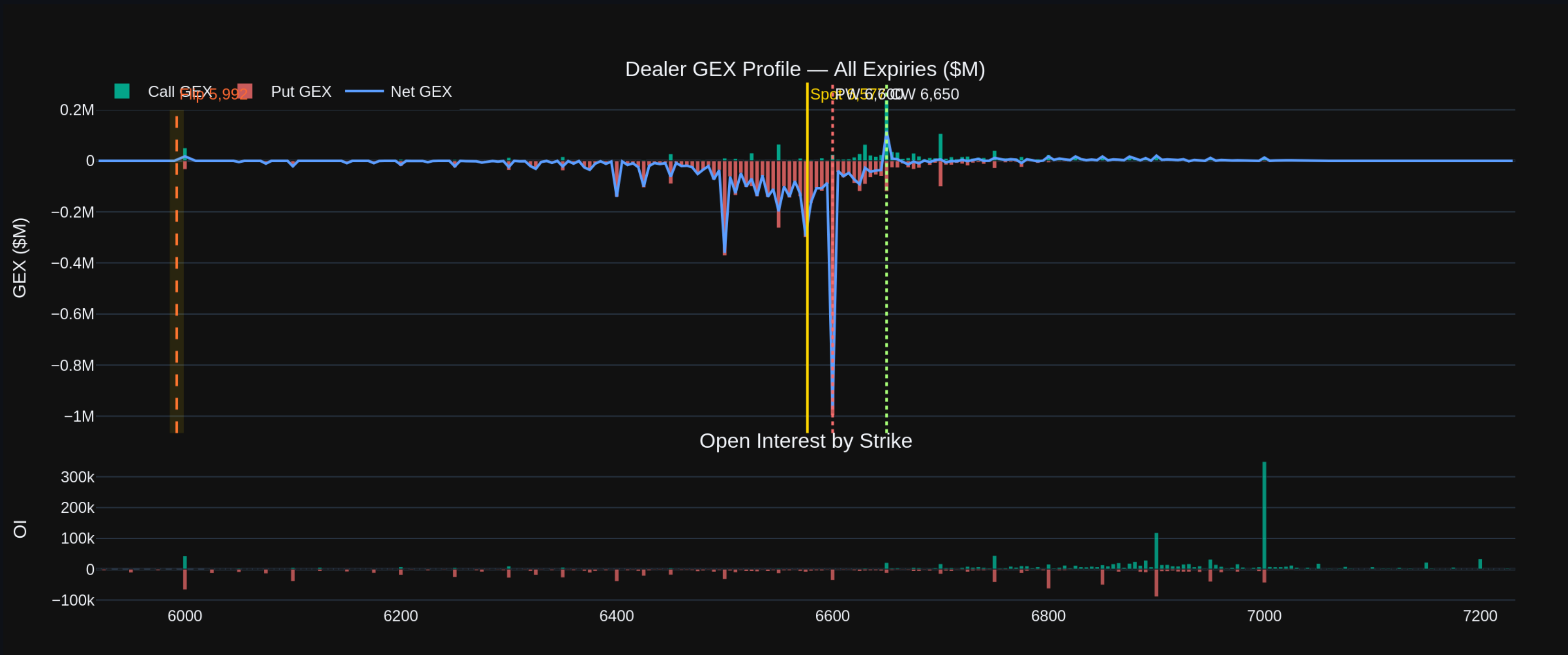

KEY LEVELS

STRIKE	TYPE	GEX	DIST. FROM SPOT	INTERPRETATION
6,650	Call Wall	+238.0B	+1.1%	Strong resistance / dealer selling above spot
6,700	Call Wall	+107.2B	+1.9%	Strong resistance / dealer selling above spot
6,550	Call Wall	+65.4B	-0.4%	Below-spot call concentration / dealer buyback support
6,600	Put Wall	-998.1B	+0.4%	Near-ATM pin/magnet (+0.4%) — ITM put concentration; dealers long delta that unwinds if spot closes above this strike
6,500	Put Wall	-371.3B	-1.2%	Downside accelerator / dealer selling pressure below spot
6,575	Put Wall	-299.9B	-0.0%	Downside accelerator / dealer selling pressure below spot

OPEX: 2026-03-20 (1 DTE)

Net GEX Expiring	% of Total Book
$-1678602M	36.0%

Expiry Roll-Off & Delta Exposure

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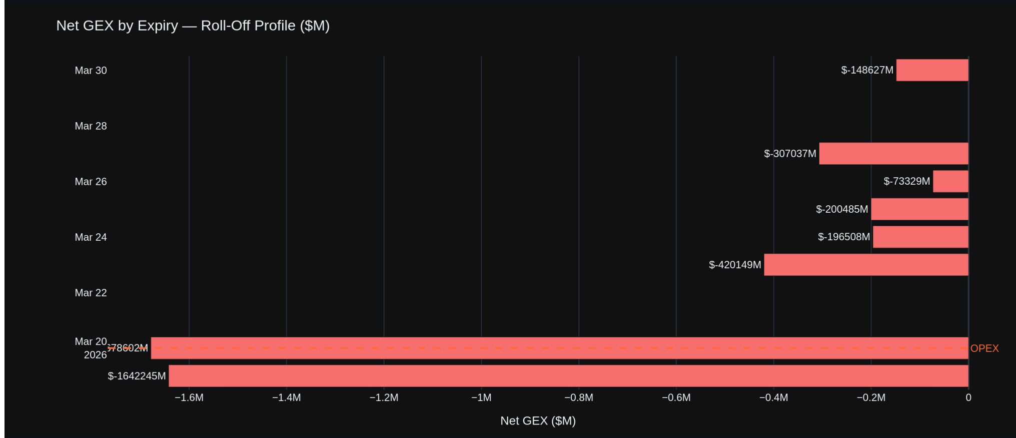
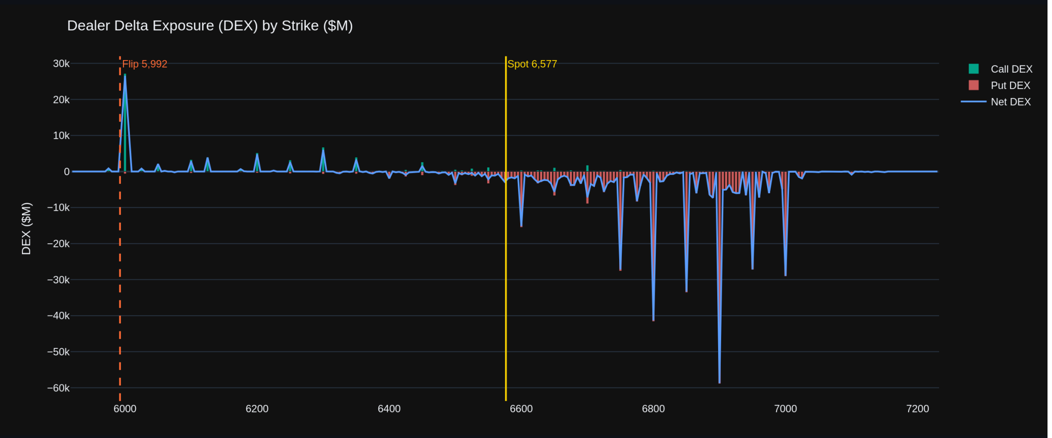
GEX BY EXPIRY



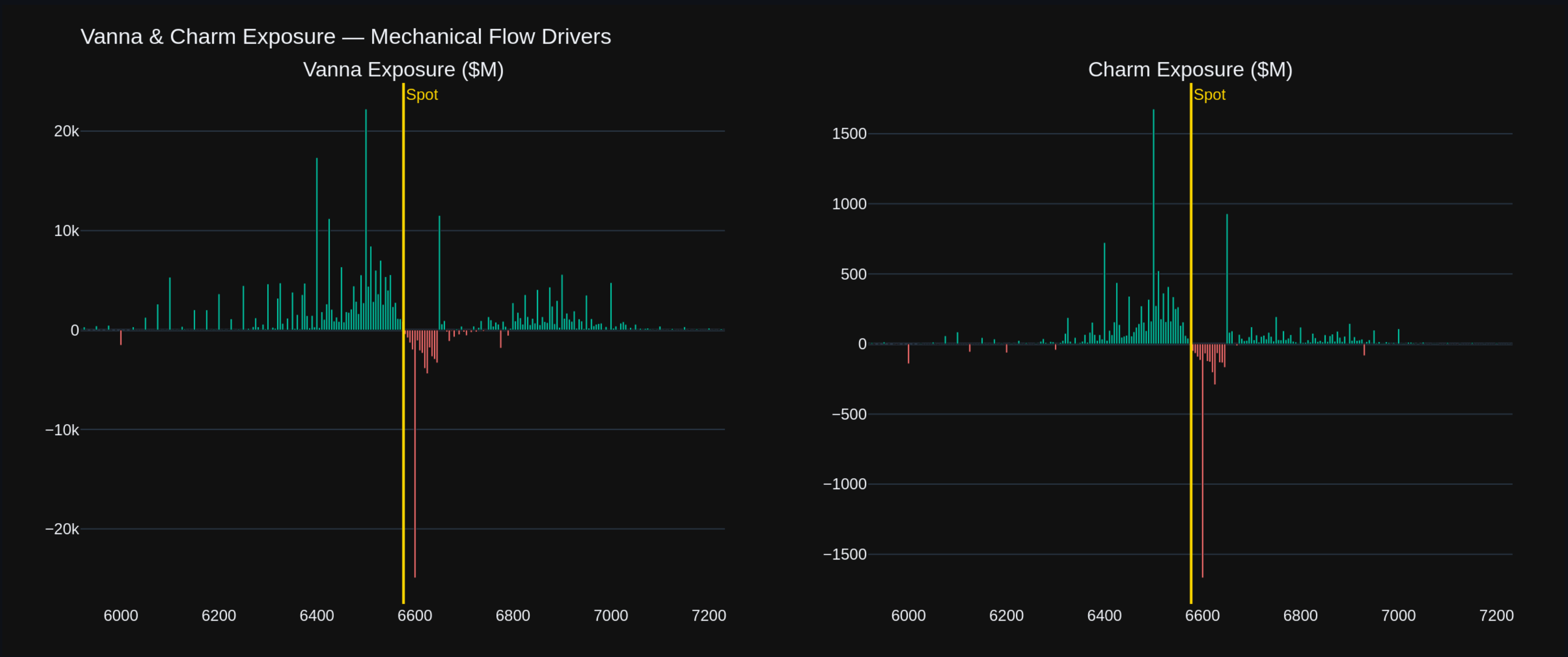
DEX PROFILE



OPEX-SPECIFIC GEX (2026-03-20)

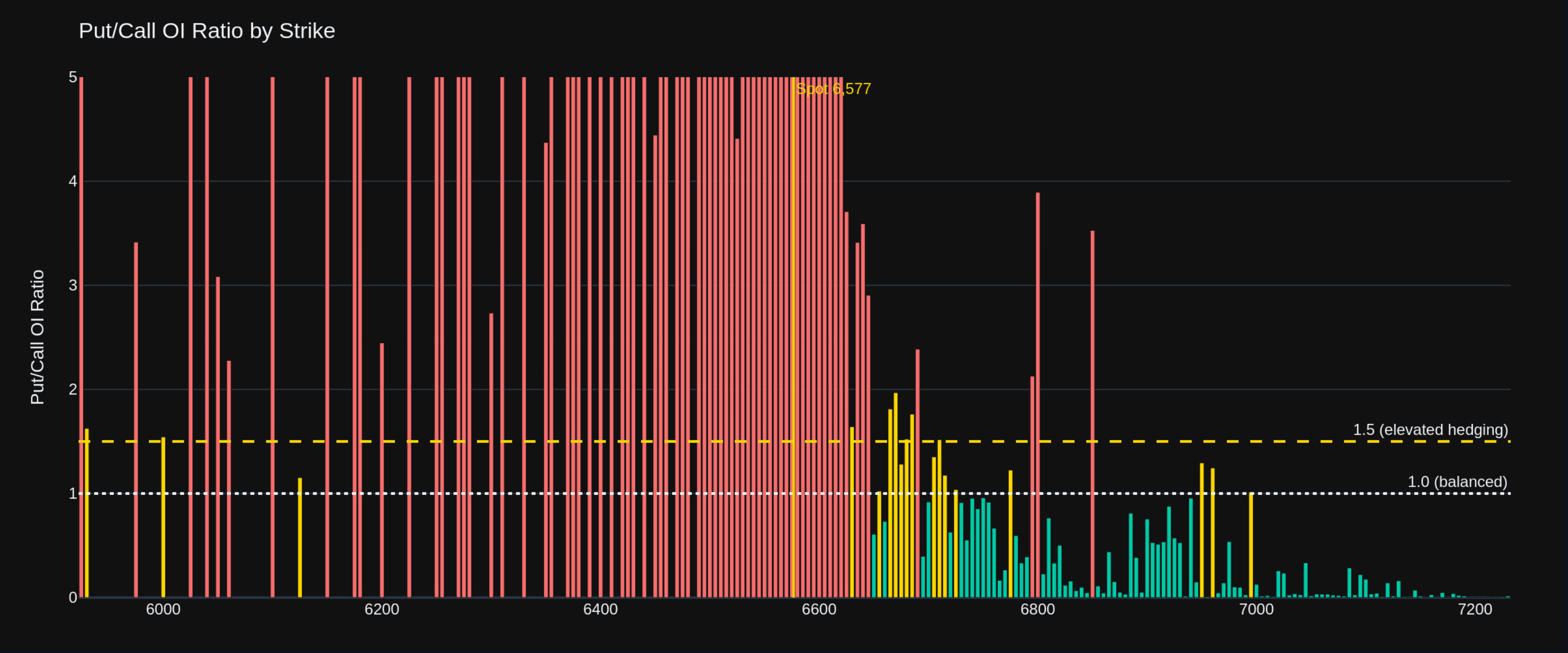
Max Pain: 6,690 — Market tends to gravitate toward max-pain strike in the final trading sessions before OPEX as dealers neutralise hedges.

VANNA & CHARM EXPOSURE



Vanna: dDelta/dSigma — when vol changes, dealers re-hedge delta mechanically. Positive vanna = vol compression drives equity buying. **Charm:** dDelta/dT — daily delta decay creates intraday mechanical flows even without price movement. Strongest near OPEX.

PUT/CALL OI RATIO



Put/Call Ratio: Values above 1.5 signal heavy defensive hedging by institutions. Put walls represent strikes with heavy short-put dealer exposure — dealer delta selling below these levels can accelerate declines.

Macro Signal Dashboard

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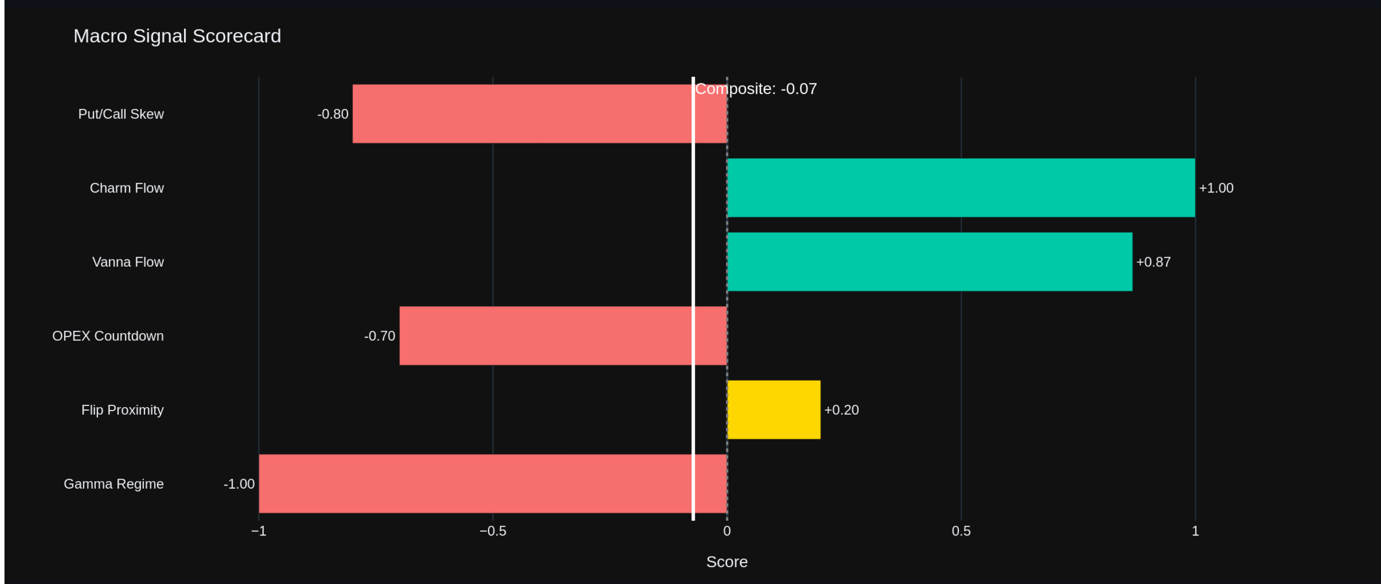

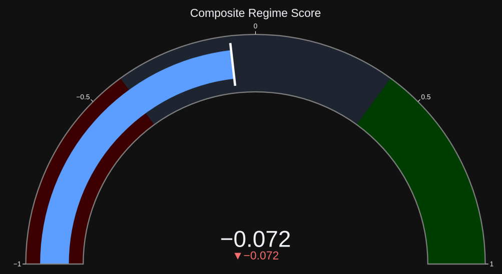

SIGNAL DETAIL

Gamma Regime

BEARISH_VOL_BUY

-1.00

STRONG

Net GEX = $-4666.98B → dealers are SHORT GAMMA. Spot is 8.9% above gamma flip at 5,992.

- Equities: trending moves more likely, reduce net delta exposure
- Vol: VIX spikes may persist — avoid short vol
- Options: long gamma / straddles for directional flexibility

Flip Proximity

ABOVE FLIP: STABLE

+0.20

WEAK

Spot (6,577) is 8.9% above gamma flip (5,992). Dealer support likely on dips toward flip.

- Watch 5,992 as key inflection — sustained close above = regime shift
- Volatility clustering risk increases near flip

OPEX Countdown

OPEX 1DTE

-0.70

STRONG

OPEX in 1 DTE (CRITICAL urgency). $-1678602M net GEX expiring = 36.0% of total book. Pin behaviour likely near OPEX strikes.

- Pin risk: market may gravitate to max-pain strike ±0.5% as OPEX approaches
- Post-OPEX: expect vol reset once large GEX concentration expires
- Book impact: 36.0% of dealer delta hedging unwind at OPEX

Vanna Flow

VOL_FALL_BID_DAMPENED

+0.87

STRONG

Vanna exposure = $+234858M. Vol compression → mechanical equity bid via delta re-hedging. VIX 1d change: +0.67 (rising) — diverging with vanna signal.

- Vol decline → dealer delta re-hedging creates systematic equity buying
- Watch VIX 1d direction as leading indicator of vanna flow direction
- Strong positive vanna + falling VIX = powerful mechanical tailwind

Charm Flow

DAILY_DELTA_INFLOW

+1.00

STRONG

Charm exposure = $+10137M/day. DTE=0: charm acceleration is sharp near expiry. Positive charm = net delta accrual as time passes.

- Charm creates mechanical daily delta flows even with no price movement
- Near OPEX, charm accelerates and can distort intraday price action

Put/Call Skew

BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY

-0.80

STRONG

Put/Call GEX ratio = 3.99. Heavy put protection in dealer books — bearish defensive positioning. Put wall at 6,600 (+0.4% from spot).

- High put skew: dealers short puts → forced to sell into weakness, amplifying downside moves
- Hedging demand exceeds upside speculation — institutional risk-off signal

Multi-Instrument Positioning

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CROSS-ASSET GEX SUMMARY

INSTRUMENT	SPOT	NET GEX ($B)	REGIME	FLIP LEVEL	DIST. TO FLIP	CALL WALL	PUT WALL
SPX — S&P 500 Index	6,576.65	**-4666.98B**	**SHORT GAMMA**	5,992.42	**+8.9%**	**6,650**	**6,600**
SPY — SPDR S&P 500 ETF	658.51	**-1527.45B**	**SHORT GAMMA**	722.00	**-9.6%**	**660**	**660**
QQQ — Invesco QQQ ETF	nan	**+0.00B**	**LONG GAMMA**	205.00	**+0.0%**	**205**	**205**
IWM — iShares Russell 2000 ETF	245.70	**-344.34B**	**SHORT GAMMA**	267.50	**-8.9%**	**245**	**240**

⚠ REGIME DIVERGENCE DETECTED — Long-gamma: QQQ; Short-gamma: SPX, SPY, IWM. Mixed positioning: dealers absorbing moves in long-gamma names while amplifying them in short-gamma names.

Divergence between QQQ (long-gamma, stable) and SPX, SPY, IWM (short-gamma, trending) signals potential sector rotation or flow concentration risk. Monitor cross-asset vol and relative GEX size to assess which regime is dominant.